

The Anointing of the Believer

Last week, I could not help but teach you into more fellowship with God if I possibly could. I knew nothing else would come out of me. Through the whole early service, the only thing the mind of Christ moved through me in was what Satan wanted.

Lucifer knew what brought God extreme pleasure. Before our creation, in all the different places in heaven, Satan, then known as Lucifer, moved in his beauty. He was deceived by his own brightness, and his wisdom was corrupted by his own beauty.

The instruments of worship, the pipes created in him the day he was created, were part of him. He was the sum total, perfect in all his ways. When he would go into a place in heaven where creation was, I imagine, if you know anything about harmony, that is what was created in him as the sum total. He was harmony. He was beauty. He was the anointed cherub that covered.

When he entered a place in heaven, or a section of heaven, or anything God occupied, the beauty and harmony he carried as the covering alongside God would cause creation to see him and be struck with beauty and worship.

This being under God, this covering, was up until that point the sum total of God's creation and beauty. He saw the great pleasure worship brought the Father.

The word worship is a word God had to create between created and Creator. It does not work anywhere else. It cannot go on between created and created. Satan found that out. The second commandment says not to bow down to or worship anything created. That word is reserved for the Creator.

All things consist in God, by Him, through Him, and for Him. That means more than exist. Something could exist and then exist through something else later, but all things consist by Him. They are made of Him, through Him, for Him, and by Him. So you will not worship anything created.

This is why Paul, when he received that great revelation in Galatians 3 and 4 about the law being the schoolmaster to the Jew, used that nation to school the whole world. The whole world could see that the law could not save you.

The law was the schoolmaster for Israel. It said, in effect, "I have a ruler in my hand. I am the schoolmaster, and I am going to slap you on the hand." It was supposed to school Israel in what they needed to inherit from the Father.

Paul kept telling the Jews, "You want to be under the law? Then hear what I have to say. The servant is no different than the heir." They are both under tutors and governors until the time appointed of the Father.

The school had Ten Commandments that said, "You have to keep these, or you will not inherit the household of your Father forever." As hard as the Jew sat under the schoolmaster, the Ten Commandments, and tried to perform them, he could not because of his death nature.

In that, the Jew was no different than the common slave of the household, even though he was heir of all. He could no more inherit than the slave of sin could inherit, because he was also a slave of sin. The law was the schoolmaster that proved that to him.

That was the birth of Romans 7. Paul finally conceded, "What I would do, I cannot; and what I will not do, I end up doing." Then he concluded, "It is no longer I that do it, but sin that dwelleth in me."

With his mind, he received the Ten Commandments and tried to keep the commandments of his God. But something working in his members would not let him. It was not his will to do those things, but there was a nature in him that would not let him do anything else.

"O wretched man that I am! Who shall deliver me from this body of death?"

Then he gave his own answer: "I thank God through Jesus Christ our Lord."

The Jews had a schoolmaster saying, "You cannot inherit until you can keep this law." We are not talking about animal sacrifice as though that could solve the problem. Scripture says it is impossible for the blood of bulls and goats to take away sin, especially the consciousness of sin and the old nature. If those sacrifices could have done that, they would have ceased to be offered.

All they could afford was an operation of accounted righteousness. As long as Israel operated in it, righteousness was added to their account and charged to the cross. If the cross had never come, all accounted righteousness would have had to come to an end. If Jesus had failed in redemption, everybody in Abraham's bosom would have dropped one degree lower and been in hell itself.

But He did not fail. He let us out. He let them out. He delivered the new nature.

Then came Jesus, born of a woman and born under the law, according to Galatians 4. Because He was born under the law, He was under obligation to keep and fulfill it. He did.

What made Him different from every other Jew was that He was able to fulfill the law, not by animal sacrifice, but by new nature. He was the first man from Adam who could do it.

Sometimes we confuse the curse of the law. The curse of the law is that a Jew has the Ten Commandments and cannot keep them. No matter how hard he tries, no matter how long he waits, he cannot keep it.

Somebody had to become that curse.

Jesus first fulfilled the law, being born of a woman and born under it. Then, when He had done that, He stepped into the shoes of every Jew who could not and became the curse of the law to free those under the curse, so they could receive the adoption of sons.

Now that you are sons, why would you go back under the weak and beggarly elements of the world, doing service to things which by nature are no gods? You have been born again. You are His sons and daughters. You belong to His family. You operate now out of that new nature, and you have to do service to no other.

Why did God create man and every other creation as such a vast family? What does He want? Why does He want us around Him?

He is self-sufficient, self-consistent, the fullness of everything that is. He is the great I Am: past, present, and future. He is all that there is or ever will be, past, present, and future.

What are you doing here?

You are a lot more trouble than we would think you were worth. Then again, we do not think like Him. You were a lot of trouble to redeem.

Hebrews says of the angels, "Who maketh his angels spirits, and his ministers a flame of fire." Each angel came into existence at the hand of God through creation.

Not you.

To the angels, He said He made them spirits and flames of fire. But to the Son He said, "Thou art my Son; this day have I begotten thee."

The angels were made. The Son was born. Keep this in mind: He was the firstborn. There is no use putting a title like firstborn unless somewhere down the line there will be two, three, four, five, six, seven, eight, nine, and ten. When you get there, ask Him what number you were.

The Father actually took from within Himself. In your order, you were born.

When God formed Adam's body, He formed it out of something that already existed, the dust of the earth. That came from creation. Everything came from the second Person of the Godhead, whom we know as Jesus, the Word, the Creator.

But when it came time for Adam's creation, God stopped and breathed. Isn't that interesting? He stopped creating.

Do you think it was a problem for Him to fashion a man's body out of a planet He had placed in the solar system ages before? Do you think it was any problem for Him to take molecules and atoms, rearrange them, set them into working order, and put life in them?

The technology today is DNA, programming, and changing. They are trying to fight disease by going to the root of it, because they found that DNA operates under such law that if you want to change something, you go to the beginning of it and change how it is made.

Can you imagine God feeding a planet by putting the DNA of a kind into seeds? Put those seeds in soil after thousands of years, and they come to life. One strand after another releases energy, and where you only had one seed, you have a whole harvest.

God set all these things into motion. That is where real prosperity is: being able to put your hand, finger, and wisdom on God's system. If it breaks down, He will step in with a miracle. If they throw you in jail for righteousness' sake and you cannot govern your affairs, He will step in with a miracle.

But if you are always trying to force Him to operate outside the laws He put in place to meet your needs so you can prove He is God, He does not perform like that for you. He does not need proof to know He is God. You should believe what He says in His Word.

God created angel spirits. He has the DNA for spirit, and He created them. But after He fashioned Adam's body into something workable, He stopped and breathed.

The word breath means it came from the inside of God, just as your breath represents your life and comes from inside you. The body without the spirit is dead; literally, the body without the breath is dead.

When God breathed into Adam, He took His very life from inside His Person and put it into him. He took something that already existed as part of Himself.

This unravels the mystery when Jesus spoke to Nicodemus.

Nicodemus said, "Must I enter my mother's womb a second time?"

Jesus said, "That which is born of the flesh is flesh." You have already been born the first time. That is when your spirit came into existence from the law of Genesis. But He said, "That which is born of the Spirit is spirit."

Then He explained it:

The wind bloweth where it listeth, and thou hearest the sound thereof, but canst not tell whence it cometh, and whither it goeth: so is every one that is born of the Spirit.

The word for wind there is the same kind of word as when God breathed into Adam the breath of life. In the kingdom of heaven, the omnipresence of the Holy Spirit means there is nowhere He is not with the breath of God. In the lowest places of the earth, you can bow your knee to the Lord Jesus Christ, and the same breath blown into Adam is going to be blown into you. You are going to be made a new creation.

Air is a marvelous creation of God. If He does not hold it to the earth with gravity, you and I cannot breathe. But what makes you think God is dependent on anything He created? How could He create something that has to keep Him alive?

The same way your breath keeps you alive, what keeps your spirit alive is that it came from inside God. The problem is that it never will cease to exist. It only dies in the sense that, because of Adam, we received the sin nature and call that death.

You had better get after your friends, because there will never be a time when they will not exist. Where they exist is the choice being made now. How much reward you have is the choice you are making now by what you do with what God gave you.

We were taken from inside God in our original creation. We were born. Then, when we fell, we had to be born again.

I have been born again. I have had a second infusion of life by the breath of God.

When did you have the first one? In the first man, Adam. When did you have the last one? In the last man, Adam.

Worship can only go on between created and Creator. I am in the family of God. I have been born of Him. I am His son, but He is God. Worship can go on between me and Him.

Why did He want me? That is the question. Why did He fill creation with life, and in particular, why with family? What does He want from me?

If you can figure that out, you can figure out what to give Him.

Hallelujah.

When Jesus said to the Father, "The glory which You gave Me," and then turned to us and said, "My glory I give unto you," He was giving us the standing He holds in His humanity.

When I figure out what He created me for, it must be something that goes on between created and Creator. Whatever He wants from me is what He has always wanted from creation, even before our creation.

Lucifer was the sum total of beauty, harmony, and worship, the anointed cherub that covered, the representation of God. No matter what part of heaven he entered, when conscious created beings saw him, it struck worship into them.

Obviously this brought God something. This fellowship required Him to create a word. It is between you and Him. What goes on between Him and creation is called worship.

We look at it from a created perspective. We think, "He is God, so He has a right to be worshiped." We look at it in legal terms, as though He is some egomaniac who wants everyone lying around saying, "We worship You. We exalt You."

But much of that attitude was developed during man's realm of spiritual death, false religion, and sacrifice. It is not the same thing that goes on between us and Him now that we are His sons and daughters and have this new nature.

Now that you have this nature and you are His sons and daughters, you need to rethink the word worship. It is better coined as fellowship and time spent with Him.

When we start out with our minds, we use statements and phrases of adoration: "I love You. I worship You. I glorify You." He loves it, and that worship begins to be received. But He is heading for the day He can come and make His abode with you, surround you with a permanent presence, and establish a rapport between you and Him as son and Father.

That is what He is after.

Worship brings God great pleasure. That is the one thing Satan wanted. If you want proof, look at the temptation in the wilderness:

"Look at the kingdoms of the world and the glory of them. Get down and worship me."

Three and a half years later, Jesus, the embodiment of God, would kneel before the race Satan had coaxed into rebellion, death, and even worshipping him. The same Man who would not bow down for the glory of the kingdoms chose the cross. He would not bow to Satan, but He got down on His knees and washed the filth of the trail off an inferior, fallen race of people, and later chose to go to the cross for them.

Half of the word worship is my interaction with Him: "I love You. I worship You. I glorify You." His part, the better coining of the word, is fellowship: total fellowship and communion with the Father as your Father and you as His son. That is all He wanted from the beginning.

When He first tried to coax me into this kind of worship three years ago or so, I saw a rock land in a pond. The ripples left the rock, one ripple pushing another into every nook and cranny until the whole pond was full from one rock.

I said, "What was that vision?"

He said, "If you would go home and worship Me all night, you would find out."

I did not. A year later, when He slew me in the power, He ordered me into the closet. He knew I would obey then. I found out about it and felt extremely dumb for wasting a year.

When you begin to worship, the rock lands in the pond. That is your spirit. Jesus told the woman that if she drank of that well, it would spring up into everlasting life. That well was the born-again spirit and everything it would bring you.

The Holy Ghost is a river. Your born-again spirit is a well. It will not run out because it is being fed by the river of God.

The fellowship with the Father saturated the spirit. Then those same waves saturated the soul. I call that the baptism of the senses, and it tilted my faith over onto God's side. I won the war of the senses. Then came the baptism of my geography, where now I lift my hands and He comes and wants to fill the room.

It was not long after that I found there was healing, faith, and everything in that presence. Everything we look for so hard and try to figure the laws for, I found out He called an anointing. Because it is available to every believer, it is the anointing of the believer.

That means these signs shall follow them that believe. It is for every single believer. When He comes and lives with you, you and Him reconcile the world together. The signs of the believer will follow you like drinking water. You lay hands on the sick and they recover. You speak with new tongues and cast devils out.

The first time I was with my friends in Phoenix, the meeting was over and the gift of my office had lifted off me. I was in the back room fellowshiping, dead-weight tired.

The pastor's wife came back and said, "I cannot bend my thumb."

I reached up, and I knew the difference. The anointing came from the worship room and filled the place. I reached over, took her thumb, and prayed. It straightened out.

Then a seventeen-year-old blind boy, the elder's son from the same church, got down on his knees in front of me, and God opened his eye. It was the anointing of the believer again.

In our camp meeting, a man came through the office after pulling tendons in his foot. He was hobbling on a crutch. I got down to pray, and the anointing of the believer filled the room. I grabbed his foot and could feel the fire. I had not quite figured it out yet, but he got up and walked off.

I was finding out there was healing in that presence, along with everything else, because it belongs to the believer, not to my office.

Never had I seen it operate so much as in those three weeks before I headed for Brazil. One week was an extension because I could not stop.

In six weeks, meeting after meeting, we sent six major miracles back to Lee College.

One man was having a heart attack. His left side was going numb and hurting terribly. He called me on my cell phone after a morning meeting and said, "I am having a heart attack."

I said, "Glory to God. Raise your hands."

The anointing of the believer came on both of us. He almost ran off the road and went into hilarious laughter. The only thing he could say was, "All the pain is gone. Everything is gone."

He pulled over and laughed for fifteen minutes before he could get back on the road. When I got home, I heard the rest of the story. It all left, every bit of it. He went home and slept for twelve hours straight. Something switched.

Any God who can go from Cleveland, Tennessee, over a wire and take your heart attack away in the middle of driving is some kind of God.

Then I went back up, and the New York ladies were listening to these things on tape. They had a seventy-year-old, seventy-pound friend who was dying in the last stages of cancer, getting transfusions.

I got to Gatlinburg, and they came in the first day saying, "We came because we want to put you on the phone with her."

I said, "What is the matter?"

"Seventy pounds, blood transfusions, lying on the bed full of pain, dying of liver cancer."

After I taught, we went down to the room, called her, and got her on the phone. I said, "Which hand do you have the phone in? Raise the other one."

She did, and she burst into hilarious laughter. I was trying to talk to her and could not. Finally I gave the phone back to the New York ladies and said, "She is healed."

They could not get through for two or three more days. When they finally did, she said, "You do not understand. I was seventy pounds, and now all the pain is gone. I have been in pain so long, and it is gone."

Then a preacher came, and we prayed over a cloth. He brought it back to his friend, whose cancer was in his liver. His liver was so full of cancer that he was already getting cold because his circulation was shutting down. He was on a life machine.

They laid the cloth on him, and his temperature came up.

Paul was not showing off. From one place, he reached all of Asia Minor. All the villages could not come and listen to him, although he received all who came. Finally Paul started praying over cloths to send them back. The people would carry them back and say, "This man prayed over this cloth," and miracles took place in their villages because their faith was connected to that tangible point of contact.

By the time the man who brought the cloth got to Gatlinburg, I said, "Where is the man now?"

He said, "Right now he is mowing his lawn."

Then another lady came up at 5:23 and said, "My son turned his knee and completely wrenched it. He is facing an operation. Could I have prayer for my son?"

It was 5:23 because I looked at my watch. We prayed. I said, "You are going to have to call him." She did not call, because she and her husband had to leave the next day.

When they got home, they asked, "How is your knee?"

He said, "Yesterday I was walking across the room, and it popped real loud and completely quit hurting."

People in the room could hear it pop.

They asked, "What time was that?"

He said, "About 5:30."

That was exactly the moment we prayed. The doctor later said, "I do not know about this, but he does not need an operation now."

What have we messed up?

Were we not supposed to gather you together as pastors? Were we not supposed to avoid forsaking the assembling of ourselves together? In those days most people did not read, so they were taught firsthand. They were taught to pray in the Holy Ghost and receive doctrine from the apostles. They leaned heavily upon the pastors because they could not read.

Then, especially in the early church, they went into their cities and immediately broke bread from house to house.

What have we done? What have we done holed up in four walls where we conduct all our business?

I have to rethink that.

Prayer center, be careful what you do with this.